

RELIGION AND MORALITY

FOUR RELATION MODELS → DIVINE COMMAND THEORY → EUTHYPHRO AND MODIFIED DCT → KANT AND NATURAL LAW → INDIAN MORAL GROUNDING → MOTIVATION AND CONDUCT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW

SUBORDINATE EXTRA

APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00FOUR RELATION MODELS

FOUR RELATION MODELS

RELIGION AND MORALITY

MORALITY REQUIRES GOD/REVELATION

MORAL TRUTH IS AUTONOMOUS

MORALITY IS INDEPENDENT BUT RELIGION MOTIVATES/SUSTAINS IT

RELIGIOUS COMMAND OR IDENTITY CAN CONFLICT WITH MORAL JUDGEMENT

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

RELIGION AND MORALITY

DEPENDENCE: morality requires God/revelation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

INDEPENDENCE: moral truth is autonomous

SUPPORT: morality is independent but religion motivates/sustains it

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

TENSION: religious command or identity can conflict with moral judgement separate ontology (what makes right), epistemology (how known),

one answer need not settle all four.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion may ground, reveal, motivate or sanction morality, and these four dependence claims must be assessed separately.

01

STAGE 01DIVINE COMMAND THEORY

DIVINE COMMAND THEORY

GOD COMMANDS X

X IS OBLIGATORY attractions

OBJECTIVE AUTHORITY

CATEGORICAL DEMAND

MOTIVATION VERSIONS

RIGHTNESS CONSTITUTED BY COMMAND EPISTEMIC

REVELATION TELLS US INDEPENDENTLY GROUNDED MORAL TRUTH MOTIVATIONAL

GOD COMMANDS X → X IS OBLIGATORY attractions: objective authority

categorical demand

motivation versions

voluntarist: rightness constituted by command epistemic: revelation tells us independently grounded moral truth motivational: love/judgement

command identification, conflicting revelations, autonomy and arbitrariness.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

GOD COMMANDS X → X IS OBLIGATORY attractions: objective authority

categorical demand

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

motivation versions

voluntarist: rightness constituted by command epistemic: revelation tells us independently grounded moral truth motivational: love/judgement strengthens compliance pressure

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

command identification, conflicting revelations, autonomy and arbitrariness.

GOD COMMANDS X → X IS OBLIGATORY attractions: objective authority

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Divine command gives obligation authoritative force but faces the dilemma between arbitrary will and independently intelligible goodness.

02

STAGE 02EUTHYPHRO AND MODIFIED DCT

EUTHYPHRO AND MODIFIED DCT

IS X GOOD BECAUSE GOD COMMANDS IT?

MORALITY APPEARS ARBITRARY; CRUELTY COULD BECOME RIGHT

GOODNESS IS INDEPENDENT; GOD IS NOT ITS FOUNDATION

MODIFIED DIVINE COMMAND THEORY

GOD'S NECESSARILY LOVING/GOOD NATURE GROUNDS VALUE DIVINE COMMANDS FLOWING

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

IS X GOOD BECAUSE GOD COMMANDS IT?

YES: morality appears arbitrary; cruelty could become right

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

NO: goodness is independent: God is not its foundation

MODIFIED DIVINE COMMAND THEORY

REPLY / RESIDUAL

God's necessarily loving/good nature grounds value divine commands flowing from that nature ground obligation reply blocks arbitrary commands

objection asks whether "good nature" is intelligible without a standard logically prior to command.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Euthyphro dilemma defeats arbitrary command, not every religious ethic; the strongest reply grounds commands in a necessarily good divine nature.

03

STAGE 03KANT AND NATURAL LAW

KANT AND NATURAL LAW

MORAL LAW ARISES FROM RATIONAL AUTONOMY, NOT HETERONOMOUS REWARD

UNIVERSAL LAW + HUMANITY AS END

GOD AND IMMORTALITY ARE PRACTICAL POSTULATES OF HIGHEST GOOD

NATURAL LAW

PRACTICAL REASON READS GOODS AND PURPOSES IN HUMAN NATURE

AQUINAS JOINS RATIONAL PARTICIPATION IN ETERNAL LAW WITH DIVINE

OBEY BECAUSE RATIONALLY RIGHT, NOT MERELY BECAUSE COMMANDED

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

KANT: moral law arises from rational autonomy, not heteronomous reward or threat categorical imperative → universal law + humanity as end

God and immortality are practical postulates of highest good, not sources of duty

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

NATURAL LAW: practical reason reads goods and purposes in human nature

Aquinas joins rational participation in eternal law with divine order contrast: obey because rationally right, not merely because commanded

EVALUATION / TRAP

religion may complete moral hope without replacing moral deliberation.

KANT: moral law arises from rational autonomy, not heteronomous reward or threat categorical imperative → universal law + humanity as end

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

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EVALUATION / TRAP

religion may complete moral hope without replacing moral deliberation.

KANT: moral law arises from rational autonomy, not heteronomous reward or threat categorical imperative → universal law + humanity as end

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: For Kant, an act has moral worth when performed from a rationally self-legislated duty, not from fear of divine punishment or hope of reward.

04

STAGE 04INDIAN MORAL GROUNDING

INDIAN MORAL GROUNDING

DHARMA KNOWN THROUGH AUTHORLESS VEDA; APŪRVA LINKS RITUAL ACT

GOD ADMINISTERS KARMA, BUT DESERTS ARISE FROM AGENTS' ACTS

INTENTION, COMPASSION AND NON-HARM WITHIN DEPENDENT ORIGINATION; NO CREATOR

AHIMSĀ AND VOWS PURIFY JĪVA BY BLOCKING KARMIC INFLUX

DHARMA, NISKĀMA KARMA, DEVOTION AND KNOWLEDGE RESHAPE AGENCY

INDIAN ETHICS SHOWS OBJECTIVE DISCIPLINE WITHOUT ONE UNIFORM DIVINE-COMMAND

MĪMĀMSĀ: dharma known through authorless Veda; apūrvā links ritual act and result

NYĀYA: God administers karma, but deserts arise from agents' acts

BUDDHISM: intention, compassion and non-harm within dependent origination; no creator

JAINISM: ahimsā and vows purify jīva by blocking karmic influx

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

MĪMĀMSĀ: dharma known through authorless Veda; apūrvā links ritual act and result

NYĀYA: God administers karma, but deserts arise from agents' acts

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

BUDDHISM: intention, compassion and non-harm within dependent origination; no creator

JAINISM: ahimsā and vows purify jīva by blocking karmic influx

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ĠTĀ/VEDĀNTA: dharma, niskāma karma, devotion and knowledge reshape agency

Indian ethics shows objective discipline without one uniform divine-command model.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian moral grounding ranges from Vedic duty and karma to non-theistic compassion, so dharma cannot be reduced to divine command.

05

STAGE 05MOTIVATION AND CONDUCT

MOTIVATION AND CONDUCT

WHY BE MORAL?

FEAR OF PUNISHMENT

HOPE OF REWARD

SOCIAL BELONGING

RESPECT FOR PERSONS

LOVE OF GOOD/GOD LOWER MOTIVES MAY SECURE COMPLIANCE BUT

IT CAN ALSO RATIONALISE BIAS WHEN IDENTITY OUTRUNS UNIVERSAL

WHY BE MORAL?

fear of punishment → hope of reward → social belonging → character/virtue

respect for persons → compassion → love of good/God lower motives may secure compliance but

religiosity can support self-control, service and forgiveness

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

WHY BE MORAL?

fear of punishment → hope of reward → social belonging → character/virtue

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

respect for persons → compassion → love of good/God lower motives may secure compliance but not moral maturity

religiosity can support self-control, service and forgiveness

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

it can also rationalise bias when identity outruns universal concern

TEST: conduct and reasons, not ritual profession alone, reveal moral integration.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion can intensify moral motivation through identity, exemplars, community and accountability, but religiosity is neither necessary nor sufficient for moral conduct.

06

STAGE 06VIOLENCE, NIETZSCHE AND MORAL CRITIQUE

VIOLENCE, NIETZSCHE AND MORAL CRITIQUE

RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY

RITUAL PURITY OR ORTHODOXY DETACHED FROM JUSTICE/COMPASSION

VIOLENCE PATH

EXCLUSIVE TRUTH + SACRED AUTHORISATION + DEHUMANISED OUT-GROUP POLITICAL

MORAL DISENGAGEMENT SAFEGUARDS

INTERPRETATION, CONSCIENCE, RIGHTS, PLURAL INSTITUTIONS, NON-VIOLENCE

GENEALOGY EXPOSES RESENTMENT AND LIFE-DENYING SLAVE MORALITY OBJECTION TO

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY: ritual purity or orthodoxy detached from justice/compassion

VIOLENCE PATH: exclusive truth + sacred authorisation + dehumanised out-group political grievance → moral disengagement safeguards: interpretation, conscience,

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

rights, plural institutions, non-violence

NIETZSCHE: genealogy exposes resentment and life-denying slave morality objection to Nietzsche: power may erase equality and protection of

REPLY / RESIDUAL

weak verdict: both religion and anti-religious critique need independent scrutiny of consequences.

RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY: ritual purity or orthodoxy detached from justice/compassion

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY: ritual purity or orthodoxy detached from justice/compassion

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REPLY / RESIDUAL

weak verdict: both religion and anti-religious critique need independent scrutiny of consequences.

RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY: ritual purity or orthodoxy detached from justice/compassion

MECHANISM / VERDICT — NIETZSCHE: genealogy exposes resentment and life-denying slave morality objection to Nietzsche: power may erase equality and protection of

weak verdict: both religion and anti-religious critique need independent scrutiny of consequences.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nietzsche exposes life-denying moral genealogies, but his critique must itself answer how power protects equality and the vulnerable.

07

STAGE 07PYQ ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

PYQ ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

STATE PRECISE DEPENDENCE CLAIM

SEPARATE GROUND/KNOWLEDGE/MOTIVE/SANCTION

MODIFIED DCT

KANT/NATURAL LAW

INDIAN NON-THEISTIC AND THEISTIC MODELS

CONDUCT/VIOLENCE TEST

MORALITY NEED NOT DEPEND ON DIVINE COMMAND FOR INTELLIGIBILITY

STATE precise dependence claim → separate ground/knowledge/motive/sanction

DCT → Euthyphro → modified DCT → Kant/natural law

Indian non-theistic and theistic models → conduct/violence test → verdict

CLOSE: morality need not depend on divine command for intelligibility, yet religion can deepen moral

its legitimacy depends on whether faith remains answerable to reason, dignity and justice.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

STATE precise dependence claim → separate ground/knowledge/motive/sanction

DCT → Euthyphro → modified DCT → Kant/natural law

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

Indian non-theistic and theistic models → conduct/violence test → verdict

CLOSE: morality need not depend on divine command for intelligibility, yet religion can deepen moral motivation, community and hope

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

its legitimacy depends on whether faith remains answerable to reason, dignity and justice.

STATE precise dependence claim → separate ground/knowledge/motive/sanction

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A strong answer separates validity, knowledge, motivation and sanction before comparing theistic and non-theistic moral frameworks.

E

EXTRASUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

DOCTRINE STATEMENT: MORAL OBLIGATION CONSISTS IN BEING COMMANDED BY

(1) OBLIGATION HAS AUTHORITY OVER PREFERENCE

(2) A SUPREME PERSONAL LEGISLATOR CAN ISSUE UNIVERSALLY BINDING

(3) DIVINE KNOWLEDGE AND GOODNESS SECURE RIGHT CONTENT

(4) ACCOUNTABILITY SUPPLIES MOTIVATIONAL SERIOUSNESS.

PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

Doctrine statement. Moral obligation consists in being commanded by God; modified versions ground commands in an essentially loving divine nature.

Argument.

(1) Obligation has authority over preference

ADVANCED OBJECTION

(2) a supreme personal legislator can issue universally binding commands

(3) divine knowledge and goodness secure right content

(4) accountability supplies motivational seriousness.

Presupposition. CAUTION: God exists, divine commands are knowable, and authority can generate moral reasons.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

Distinction.

Semantic dependence ("wrong" means forbidden) differs from metaphysical dependence (wrongness is constituted by prohibition) and motivational dependence (belief

Canonical example. Abrahamic command cases test whether obedience can override ordinary moral judgement.

Objection → reply.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.